



Welcome to Speech and Debate!

Wednesday, April 22nd

4/22 Agenda:

Voting Matters

- End of Year Party
- Logo

Film Crew Discussions

End of Year Party

Calendar:

Weekend Dates: April 25-26, May 2-3, May 9-10, May 16-17, May 23-24, May 30-31,
June 6-7

Ideas:

New Logo



Old Logo



Current Events

- Iran still keeping the majority of the Strait of Hormuz closed, with 10-20 passing daily compared to 120-130 which would normally pass through daily
- Ceasefire has been extended with Iran, diplomatic efforts struggling and, no timeframe has been set for reaching a peace agreement
- Iran seized two international vessels, including one today, America claims no responsibility
- Sea Ice in the Arctic Ocean drops to an “alarming new low” at a time of year when it should be highest (enough to cover the whole state or Texas)

Research Tips/Building Your Contentions

-To start your research, it can be helpful to simply search the resolution for your side on the internet.

“Why should the USFG have a moral obligation to eradicate homelessness?”

- Come up with 3-4 main points of contentions that you can build on with logical reasoning
- Come up with potential refutations for points on the opposing side

Try to avoid:

- Over focusing on statistical evidence— try to rely more on logical reasoning
- Leaving your plan to the last minute— your plan should be specific and detailed
- Writing different points/wording than your partner— in order to collaborate effectively, it is important that you and your partner have the same points and subpoints written

Practice Debate

Novice: The USFG should prohibit the sale of genetic data for commercial purposes.

JV/V: The environmental movement ought to prioritize ecocentrism over anthropocentric ecology.

Results!

Hamza and Francisco - 2-1

Aashna and Stella - 3-0

Logan and Kourosh - 3-0

Stuff We Need to Improve On

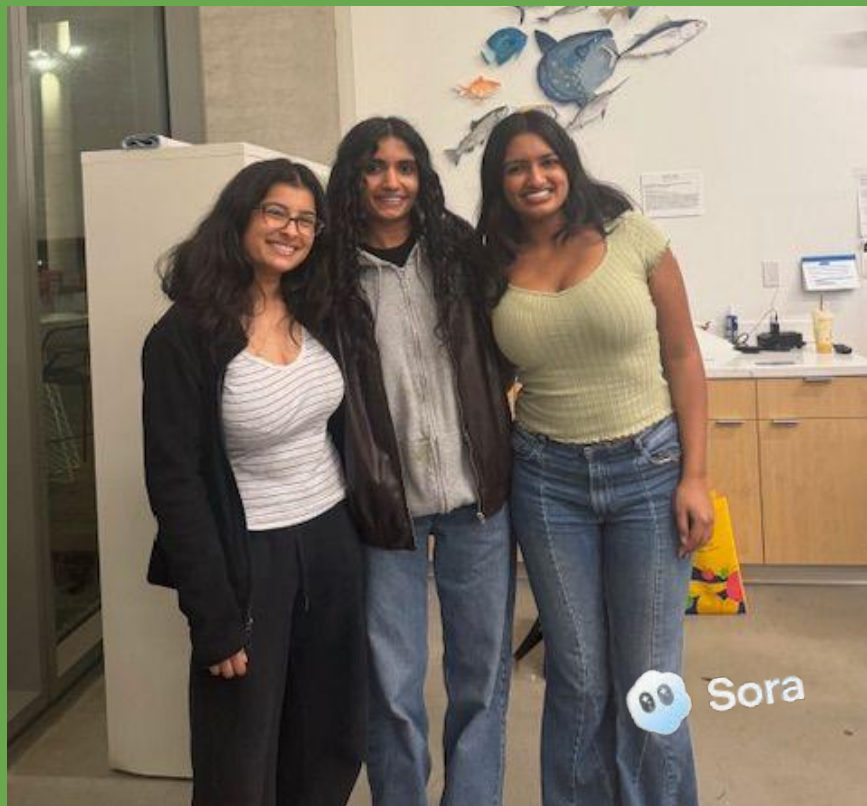
- Make sure your arguments have enough evidence
- Sound confident
- Don't just read off of the paper
- Refute all the points
- Reasoning to back up all claims
- Pacing
- Impact!!!

Stuff We Did Well

- Good anecdotal evidence
- Clear voice/speaking
- Not too much repetition

aashna made new friends yay

It's probably AI



Jon is a liar

Making an Effective Rebuttal

A rebuttal is the final speech (3 mins novice) a team makes in a debate. It is used to:

- Establish voting issues, or the points of clash that your side has won
 - You can do this by comparing the benefits and drawbacks of contentions on both sides
- Look into the future— compare the impacts of each sides
 - Two world analysis:
 - Prove why your arguments (voting issues) have won according to the judging criteria
 - For example: “For reasons ... the affirmation has proved why ... provides the most amount of good for the most amount of people, which is our weighing mechanism of net benefits.

Making an Effective Rebuttal

A rebuttal is the shorter final speech a team makes in a debate that is slightly different from other speeches:

- No new information (contention, statistic, refutation, etc.)
- Avoid restarting topics already discussed from both sides—bring in new compelling language, analogies, perspectives, or comparisons (but not information!)
- The rebuttal is the last impression on the judge
 - Be sure to thank the judges and your opponents at the end of every speech
 - Keep the points clear and make sure the other side's logic goes unrefuted

Rebuttal Strategy-Two World Analysis

- Two World Analysis: A common strategy used in policy debate rebuttals comparing the benefits and disadvantages of both cases
- Focus on impact of your case! How will it help people?
 - Say you're on the affirmation for the resolution: "The USFG (United States Federal Government) should provide universal healthcare as a fundamental right"
 - Condensed Two World Analysis: If the USFG provided universal healthcare, the world would be much better place. The result would be much healthier people, allowing more people to join the workforce and be productive members of society. On the other hand, if it wasn't provided, the American people would continue to decline in health. The death toll would raise, and healthcare would become a privilege rather than the necessity it should be.

Practice Debate (Policy)

Novice: The USFG should substantially increase its investment in space colonization.

JV/V: Carceral justice organizations should prioritize education in prisons that prepares inmates for particular jobs (e.g cooking classes) over general education (e.g psychology classes).

Language & Professionalism

PARLIAMENTARY LANGUAGE

DON'T SAY	INSTEAD SAY
I think...	My delegation considers...
I disagree with...	My delegation disagrees with the delegation of...
Poor countries...	Developing countries
Money...	Economic resources, or just resources
Rich countries...	Developed Countries
Countries were fighting because...	Nations were involved in a struggle because...
I believe...	My delegation believes...
I would like to propose an informal debate...	Motion to start a moderated caucus...
I would like to say...	My delegation would like to express its thoughts about...
All the countries...	The International Community...
Your are...	Your delegation is...
Your are wrong...	Your delegation is mistaken

REMEMBER:

1. Always speak in third person.
2. Try to speak with an elevated vocabulary.
3. Avoid colloquial expressions and sayings.
4. Avoid being vulgar or disrespectful with words.

Personal Point of View

- In my experience...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- Speaking for myself...
- In my opinion...
- Personally, I think...
- I'd say that...
- I'd suggest that...
- I'd like to point out that...
- I believe that...
- What I mean is
- I feel....
- According to me...

General Point of View

- It is thought that...
- Some people say that...
- It is considered...
- It is generally accepted that...

Agreeing with an opinion

- Of course.
- You're absolutely right.
- Yes, I (totally) agree.
- I think so too.
- That's a good point.
- Exactly.
- Absolutely !
- Precisely !
- Definitely !
- I don't think so either.
- So do I.
- I'd go along with that.
- That's true.
- Neither do I.
- I agree with you entirely.
- That's just what I was thinking.
- I have to side with you on this one....
- I suppose so....
- I couldn't agree more.

- I see exactly what you mean....
- You're right, that's a good point....
- Actually, I think you're right....
- That's true....
- Well, I agree with you here....
- You have my full agreement....
- I second that....
- Ok, that's convincing....
- I take your word on it....
- You took the words right out of my mouth....

Disagreeing with an opinion

- That's different.
- I don't agree with you.
- However...
- That's not entirely true.
- On the contrary...
- I'm sorry to disagree with you, but...
- Yes, but don't you think...
- That's not the same thing at all.
- I'm afraid I have to disagree.
- I'm not so sure about that (because...).
- I must take issue with you on that.
- It's unjustifiable to say that...
- I see your point, but...
- I completely disagree....
- I'm not sure about that....
- That's not always true....
- Well, I see things rather differently...
- I don't think so....
- You've got to be kidding...
- Not necessarily....

Adding one's opinion

- Can I add something here.... ?
- If I may interrupt...
- Before you move on, I'd like to say something....
- Sorry, but I'm not done yet....
- Sorry, but can you let me finish....
- Wait a minute....

Review of Debate Language

- What do you call the shorter final speeches in the debate?
- What is a POI?
- What is a POC?

COMMON DEBATING PHRASES

Welcoming the audience	Ladies and Gentlemen welcome to this debate. 
Stating the issue	- The motion for debate today is ... - People / Dr. Johnson... believe(s) / feel(s) / insist(s) / think(s)...that... - Let's first define some important concepts...
Phrases to present the most important point	- This argument/idea is of paramount importance. - The most important argument for ... is .../The main idea/thing is ... - The most important idea is.../The primary argument for... is... - Most importantly, I want to mention that... - Two/three... important arguments support my point of view...
Conceding an argument	- It's true/obvious/evident that ... However, ... - While you might say that ..., it's important to remember that ... - I agree with you that ... On the other hand, ... - Although/even though it is true that... I believe that... - I agree/admit/concede that..., but we must remember that... - I can understand that... Nevertheless, ...
Sequencing a list of arguments	- First of all, I'd like to state .../Firstly, ... Secondly, - The second argument in favor of ... - To begin with, .../I'd start by.../For a start, ... - The next argument I'd like to state is... 
Adding an argument to strengthen your point	- You also have to consider .../Furthermore .../Moreover... - What is more.../It might also add that.../Not only that but also... - Perhaps / maybe I should also mention.../Not to mention the fact that...
Concluding	- Let me recap/recapitulate my point .../It all boils down to ... - As a final word, let me summarize my point of view... - To reiterate my point of view, .../To sum up, .../Finally, ... 

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Screenagers Movie Trailers

<https://www.screenagersmovie.com/>

Predicting Counterarguments - Preempting

1. Flip the Case

Ask students:

“If I *had* to disagree with myself, where would I start?”

Guiding questions for them:

- What assumptions does my side rely on?
- What is the *weakest* link in our logic chain?
- What evidence would someone on the other side emphasize?

This forces them to surface the obvious counters before the other team does.

Predicting Counterarguments

2. When doing research, make sure to keep your eye out for information that negates your claim and supports the other side- this is information you need counter arguments for

3. Hold the Opposite Lens

Ask:

“What does the other side *want* the judge to believe?”

Attacking the Aff's Plan

- Workability - if AFF's plans would fail at some point, could not guarantee the advantages
- Solvency - if plan does not actually solve the problem
 - Ex: colleges require SAT again → people can still cheat on the SAT
- Inherency - status quo can already do what AFF is suggesting
 - Tell judge that this is a voting issue, status quo is already taking care of it
- Remember Fiat!!

Counterplans

In JV and Varsity divisions, the negation has the option of creating a counterplan in a policy debate to oppose the affirmation's plan.

On the affirmative side, they should have established:

- Plan
- Significant harms (contentions)
- Reasoning why the plan is needed and would solve the contentions.

This gives the negation a clearer distinction between both proposals.

Counterplans

A counterplan is an optional method of opposing the affirmative plan by proposing their own plan that competes with the affirmative one.

In order for a counterplan to be effective, it must be:

- Competitive
- Non-topical
- Solve the affirmation's need
- At minimum, equally advantageous

Making a Competitive Counterplan

There are a couple ways to show that your counterplan is competitive:

- **Mutual Exclusivity** - The plan and counterplan cannot be done at the same time.
 - Ex: Plan requires personal mandate for healthcare, CP bans the mandate
- **Net Beneficial** - The counterplan is the best of all potential options because it would result in the most benefits.
- **Solvency** - The counterplan would solve the affirmative harms. If it is proven that a counterplan cannot solve them, it is considered noncompetitive.
 - NOTE: It does not have to solve ALL of the affirmative harms, just a substantial amount.

Defending Against a Counterplan

- The counterplan can be attacked in a variety of ways, so if you decide to make one, be prepared to defend it.

A few traditional lines of attack are:

- Plan shifts: The affirmative can call out any changes in the counterplan that occur between speeches. To combat this, both partners should clearly write out your entire plan.
- Vagueness: Avoid this by having a very specific plan text that is easy to understand and ultimately defend.

Defending Against a Counterplan

A-Specs (Agent Specification): Affirmation attacks for not having valid agent of action.

E-Specs (Enforcement Specification): Affirmation attacks the method of enforcement.

Funding Specs (Funding Specification): Affirmation attacks the source/amount of funding.

Like a plan, the counter plan must include an Agent of Action, Enforcement, Timeframe, and Funding, as well as any other important details.

Arguments of permutation (Perms): Permutations test the mutual exclusivity competition of a counterplan.

Keep in Mind

- Counterplans are optional
 - If you are in a rush during prep, unsure of the resolution, or feel that a counterplan would not be the strongest option, it can be the best choice not to make one. It is better to have no counterplan than one that is noncompetitive or ineffective.
- Avoid plan specific disadvantages
 - Rather than making the argument that the plan has a significant cost (which would disadvantage the plan), instead argue that your counterplan avoids the cost. This turns their disadvantage into your own advantage.

First Lesson: Overview of Debate Basics

Affirmation/Government (pro)

- First speech (1st speaker)
 - 5 mins Novice, 7 mins JV/V
- Third speech (2nd speaker)
 - 5 mins Novice, 8 mins JV/V
- Final speech (rebuttal*) (1st speaker)
 - 3 mins Novice, 4 mins JV/V

Negation/Opposition (con)

- Second speech (1st speaker)
 - 5 mins Novice, 8 mins JV/V
- Fourth speech (2nd speaker)
 - 5 mins Novice, 8 mins JV/V
- Fifth speech (rebuttal) (1st speaker)
 - 3 mins Novice, 5 mins JV/V

*A rebuttal is a closing speech where the speaker proves to the judge why/how they have won the debate.

Types of Resolutions

There are three types of resolutions (topics) you will encounter in parliamentary debate.

- **Policy Debate** - shows that there is a problem in the status quo that requires a plan/solution
 - Often involves a change in the United States Federal Government (USFG)
 - “should” or “ought to”
 - Ex. The United States ought to guarantee universal childcare
- **Value Debate**- both sides push for their value to be prioritized over the other side’s value
 - Often uses the phrase “when in conflict”
 - Ex. When in conflict, environmental protection is prioritized over natural landscape
- **Fact Debate**-resolutions that are opinions stated as a fact (goal is to try to prove it true/false)
 - Often it is a “yes” or “no” statement
 - Ex. The death penalty benefits outweigh consequences

Framing A Debate

Framing your debate helps structure resolution, how you would like it to be judged, and how the key terms in the it are defined.

At the start of your side's first debate you must:

- Restate the FULL resolution (topic) *(Ex. In the United States, National Service ought to be mandatory)*
- Define any open ended terms *(Ex. National Service - A period of compulsory service in the armed forces of some countries during peacetime, Mandatory - required by laws or rules)*
- Establish Judging Criteria *(Ex. Net benefits, preponderance of evidence, moral imperative, etc.)*

Using Your Prep Time Efficiently

In the Novice category, you are given 30 minutes prior to your debate that can be used to structure your speeches.

- Write down the resolution (word for word) and determine whether it is a policy, fact, or value debate
- Establish judging criteria and definitions of terms
- If the debate is policy, make a plan of action
- Establish around 3 main contentions with several points of reasoning for each

Focus Point - Road Maps

A road map is a tool used in debate to guide the judge and your opponent where you will go in your debate. You think of it as a preview of what is to come in your speech.

A road map should:

- Go after you have introduced yourself, your side, and the resolution
- Not be too specific– don't explain your points, just the order in which you will address different parts of the speech
- Be off time or on time, specify to the judge whether you would like it counted in your timer
- Not be more than one sentence!

Example road map:

For a quick off time road map, in this debate I will first introduce the affirmation's definitions and judging criteria, then I will introduce our plan, and lastly, I will introduce three contentions that support our claim.

Note: Once you say your road map, you have to stick to it!

Focus Point - POIs

A POI, or a Point of Information, is a question or short statement posed by the opposing side mid speech used pick further at the opponent's arguments or help get a greater understanding of a point.

POI etiquette:

- **Be respectful and conscious of the opponent's time**
 - If accepted, POIs run into the opponent's speech time. Keep your question short and sweet, and avoid asking too many (more than two or three a speech)
 - Grace period: You can't ask a POI in the first or last minute of your opponent's speech
- **Avoid going back and forth with your opponent**
 - A POI grants you one question, you cannot respond to their answer again unless you ask another POI, which can be seen as excessive or aggressive
- **To call a POI:**
 - Stand up with your hand raised and say POI, do not ask until the opponent gives you permission to speak

Focus Point - POIs cont.

When receiving a POI, you can:

- Accept it and provide a brief answer
 - Decline it and continue with your speech
 - Save it for the end of your speech if you have any time left
-
- accepting a POI can show the judge that you are ready to defend your side on the spot, and a logical answer can help your case
 - If you are being bombarded with POI's, however, don't be afraid to decline and continue giving your speech.

Example POI:

You mentioned how your plan benefits the economy, In what way does it do so when you yourself said it could shut down local businesses?

Notice how this picks further at their claim and sets the stage for you to argue this point in the next speech.

Making a Plan

If the resolution calls for a policy debate, (current issue with status quo that requires solution) then the affirmation side must come up with a plan of action.

WHO: Who will carry out this plan? (Agent of action)

WHAT: What does the plan entail? (Details)

WHEN: When will it happen? (Timeframe)

HOW: How will it happen? (Funding/Enforcement)

Introducing Fiat

Fiat - a rule in parliamentary debate that states you must assume that the plan advocated by the affirmative team is already in action

- Plan must pass through Congress in a hypothetical world
- Do not focus your debate on whether or not Congress will approve your plan, rather focus on the merits of it

Rebuttal Basics

When preparing a rebuttal during a speech, make sure to follow a basic structure:

- No new information- you can help your partner with arguments, but DO NOT write anything down unless it is spoken in the debate as usable information
- Keep all points of clash connected- Make connections between different arguments during the debate relating to similar topics
- This includes rebuttals, defense to those rebuttals, etc; all should be kept organized and connected so you can use them in your rebuttal
- Don't write too much; focus on summarizing and then you can move on to a two-world analysis or another strategy
- DO NOT just go “down your flow” while speaking your rebuttal- instead, go over linked points (“points of clash”) one at a time

Debate Review:

How much time do you have to speak during your constructive speeches as a novice?

How much time do you have to speak in your rebuttal as a novice?

If the debate is policy and you are on the affirmative side, what do you need?

What are you NOT allowed to bring up your rebuttal?

What do you establish to for the judge to weigh the debate on?